

CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS REFERENCE EDITION

English Vocabulary in Use

Upper-Intermediate Complete 100-Unit Master Edition

UNIT 1: SUFFIXES IN NOUN FORMATION (-ISM, -IFICATION, -ITY)

A. ABSTRACT CONCEPTS & SYSTEMS (-ISM)

The suffix **-ism** forms nouns denoting doctrines, systematic theories, political practices, or typical behaviors:

- **Optimism** : The persistent belief that positive outcomes will occur.
"Despite infrastructure delays, the project team maintained their systemic optimism."
- **Bureaucratism** : Rigid adherence to administrative routines.
"The migration process was choked by organizational bureaucratism."

B. PRODUCTIVE ACTION & STATES (-IFICATION, -ITY)

Suffixes that track specific active conversion states or absolute qualities:

- **Clarification** : The action of making a statement or situation less confusing.
"We requested an immediate clarification regarding network protocols."
- **Complexity** : The state of being intricate or deeply interconnected.
"The unexpected complexity of the framework layout caused optimization delays."

Exercise 1.1: Suffix Transformation Matrix

Convert the root words in brackets using *-ism*, *-ification*, or *-ity* to perfectly fit the context:

1. The engineering department requires absolute _____ (clear) before changing the configuration rules.
2. Relying purely on blind _____ (optimist) will not fix a underlying hardware bug.
3. The sheer _____ (complex) of running large language models locally demands robust vRAM allocations.

Exercise 1.2: Contextual Proofing

Identify and correct the incorrect suffix form in each line:

1. "The project's code needs standardism before deployment."
Correction: _____
2. "We observed a high degree of flexification in their development cycles."
Correction: _____

UNIT 2: ADVANCED PREFIXES (DE-, COUNTER-, ANTI-)

A. REVERSAL AND REDUCTION (DE-)

The prefix **de-** indicates the reversal of an action, removal, or a downward trend:

- **De-escalate** : To reduce the intensity or severity of a conflict.

"Active system logging helped de-escalate the performance crisis."

- **Centralize vs. Decentralize** : Moving structural authority away from a central hub.

"They chose to decentralize their storage architecture."

B. OPPOSITION AND DEFENSE (COUNTER-, ANTI-)

Prefixes denoting deliberate pushback, strategic alignment, or total protection:

- **Counter-intuitive** : Contrary to expectations or common-sense reasoning.

"The optimal performance fix turned out to be completely counter-intuitive."

- **Antivirus / Antidote** : Agents designed to actively neutralize hostile structural elements.

Exercise 2.1: Prefix Matching Sequence

Add the correct prefix (de-, counter-, anti-) to complete the sentence sentences:

1. To prevent complete failure, the administration decided to _____grade the primary server framework.
2. Launching a _____attack against malicious network requests preserved operational uptimes.
3. The new software patch contains strong _____tampering mechanics built right into the compilation process.

UNIT 3: COMPOUND NOUNS AND ADJECTIVES IN INDUSTRY

A. STRUCTURAL COMPOUND NOUNS

Compounds combine distinct lexical units to form highly specific industry terminology:

- **Bottleneck** : A structural chokepoint that impedes steady workflows.
"A critical data bottleneck occurred within the memory controller pipeline."
- **Feedback loop** : A system where outputs are routed back as operational inputs.
"Continuous user feedback loops drive rapid application patches."

B. COMPOUND ADJECTIVES

Hyphenated multi-word descriptors determining capability, scope, or design characteristics:

- **State-of-the-art** : Incorporating the newest, most advanced features available.
"The enterprise data center features state-of-the-art thermal cooling arrays."
- **Time-consuming** : Requiring extensive duration inputs.
"Manual memory checks are an incredibly time-consuming practice."

Exercise 3.1: Structural Assembly

Match a word from Column A with Column B to solve the industry context:

Column A: Bottle | Feed | State | Time

Column B: back | neck | consuming | of-the-art

1. The process was so _____ that the engineers automated it completely using specialized code.
2. A serious _____ in the pipeline caused data packets to drop frequently.
3. They deployed a _____ system infrastructure to manage virtual resources seamlessly.

UNIT 4: FUNCTIONAL COLLOCATIONS FOR WORK & DYNAMICS

A. HIGH-FREQUENCY VERB-NOUN COUPLINGS

Upper-intermediate language avoids generic verbs like 'make' or 'do', selecting precise collocations instead:

- **Conduct an assessment** : To systematically inspect or analyze a state.

"The administrators will conduct an assessment of the GPU passthrough limits."

- **Implement a policy** : To actively put an administrative plan or configuration into effect.

"The company decided to implement a policy restricting unauthorized direct access."

B. FIXED COLLOCATIONS FOR SYSTEMATIC FAILURE

Expressions tracking systemic collapse or strategic shifts:

- **Go down the tubes** : To fail completely, rapidly, or catastrophically.

"Without immediate cooling backup, the production servers will go down the tubes."

- **Back to the drawing board** : Forced to start a design process over due to failure.

Exercise 4.1: Collocation Optimization

Replace the generic underlined verbs with professional collocations (conduct, implement, return):

1. The team needs to do an assessment of the current virtual environments.

Better: _____ an assessment

2. Management wants to put out a new strict security protocol next month.

Better: _____ a policy

Exercise 4.2: Idiomatic Application

Complete the sentences with 'the tubes' or 'drawing board':

1. If the hardware hypervisor completely freezes up during the test run, our entire weekend project goes down _____.

2. The initial server script failed to execute properly, forcing us right back to the _____.

A. VIRTUALIZATION & HARDWARE ORCHESTRATION

Navigating modern deployment environments requires precise, descriptive lexical terms:

- **Hypervisor** : Software that creates and runs virtual machines (VMs).
"The bare-metal hypervisor directly orchestrates hardware layer requests."
- **Passthrough** : Directly dedicating physical hardware components to a virtual client.
"Configuring a direct GPU passthrough removes processing latency entirely."

B. RESOURCE CONTENTION & OPTIMIZATION

Isolating and describing operational efficiency profiles:

- **Allocation** : The system-driven assignment of specific resources to distinct processes.
"Dynamic memory allocation balances active training cycles."
- **Throughput** : The actual volume of data processed through a system within a given timeframe.

Exercise 5.1: Technical Vocabulary Contextualization

Fill blanks using terms from the left panel (hypervisor, passthrough, allocation, throughput):

1. By utilizing a dedicated hardware _____, the host server safely maps physical devices to independent client environments.
2. Optimizing the cluster config dramatically improved overall data _____ across the local storage network.
3. Incorrect vRAM _____ causes the system kernel to terminate active compute tasks prematurely.